

ANE

Avarwand Name Editor

User Guide

Field	Details
Software	ANE – Avarwand Name Editor
Version	1.8
Author	Avarwand Software
Date	6 May 2026

1. Introduction

1.1 What Is ANE?

ANE (Avarwand Name Editor) is a lightweight, powerful desktop utility for Windows that lets you rename files and folders in large batches, quickly, safely, and exactly the way you want. Developed by 'Avarwand software team'. ANE was designed to handle the real-world renaming tasks that Windows Explorer *simply cannot do!*

Whether you need to clean up hundreds of downloaded media files, standardise folder names for a backup archive, or remove unwanted prefixes from thousands of log files, ANE gives you full control with a clear GUI interface, no command-line knowledge required.

1.2 Purpose of the Tool

- Rename files and folders in bulk with a single click
- Add, remove, or replace text anywhere in file and folder names
- Preview an overview of the desired change before it happens, no surprises
- Search your entire drive or any folder for specific items
- Safely move, copy, or delete found items without leaving the tool

1.3 Key Benefits

- **Fast:** Multi-threaded engine processes large directories in seconds without freezing the interface.
- **Safe:** A full preview shows you exactly what will be renamed before any change is made.
- **Simple:** Clean dark-mode GUI, no scripting, no command line.
- **Flexible:** Add, Remove, or Replace text at the beginning, end, or anywhere in names.
- **Powerful:** Subfolder recursion, case-sensitivity toggle, keyword filters, and format filters give expert-level control.
- **Non-destructive:** Files are never deleted during renaming. The Recycle Bin is used for all deletions in the Live Search tool.

2. Features

The table below summarises all major capabilities of ANE.

	Feature	Description
	Text Operations	Add text to the beginning or end of names; Remove text from anywhere; Replace any pattern with new text.
	Subfolder Support	Include Subfolders checkbox enables recursive renaming. A depth selector (1 to N levels, or Unlimited) auto-populates from the actual folder structure.
	Preview (100 items)	Before renaming, preview up to 100 affected items (10 per page). Each row shows path, type, current name, and new name. Double-click any row to open it in Explorer.
	Live Path Search	Standalone search window: search any folder by name, set subfolder depth, toggle case sensitivity, and view full paths. Runs in the background, the UI never freezes.
	Results Grid	Every rename result is logged with a # counter, previous name, new name, and colour-coded outcome (green = success, red = error). A live search bar highlights matching rows.
	File Actions	From Live Search, select any results and Copy, Move, or Delete them (Recycle Bin). Includes administrator elevation for protected files.
	Case Sensitivity	Toggle case-sensitive matching on or off for all operations. Default is ON.
	Format Filter	Restrict operations to a specific file extension (e.g. .mp3, .txt, or a custom format).
	Keyword Filter	Restrict renaming to only items whose names contain a specific word or symbol.
	CSV Export	Export the rename results grid or Live Search results to a CSV file for documentation.
	Non-Blocking Engine	All heavy operations (rename, preview scan, depth detection, search) run in background runspaces. Progress bars animate during all tasks.
	Safe Defaults	Protected OS files (desktop.ini, thumbs.db, etc.) and Office lock files (~\$) are automatically excluded from renaming and preview.

3. System Requirements

ANE is a Windows-native application. The table below lists the minimum and recommended system requirements.

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Windows 10 _(64-bit) or Windows 11 _(64-bit) or later
PowerShell	Windows PowerShell 5.1 (included with Windows 10/11), no installation needed
.NET Framework	.NET Framework 4.7 or later (pre-installed on Windows 10/11)
RAM	Minimum 512 MB free RAM Recommended 1 GB+
Disk Space	Less than 5 MB for the application itself
Screen Resolution	1024 × 768 minimum 1280 × 720 or higher recommended
Permissions	Standard user account for most operations. Administrator rights may be needed to rename or delete system-protected files.

4. Getting Started

5.1 First Launch

When ANE opens, you will see the main window divided into several clear zones:

- Path Bar , at the top, for selecting the target folder
- Settings Panel , where you choose your operation, target type, text, and filters
- Action Buttons , RENAME, EXPORT RESULTS, STOP, CLEAR RESULTS, PREVIEW (5), LIVE SEARCH
- Results Grid , the log of everything ANE renamed
- Status Bar , progress bar and status messages at the bottom

5.2 Basic Usage Overview

The typical workflow for a renaming task is:

1. Select the folder that contains the files or folders you want to rename.
2. Choose an Operation: Add, Remove, or Replace.
3. Enter the text to add, remove, or replace.
4. Optional: set a filter, adjust depth, or toggle case sensitivity.
5. Click PREVIEW (5) to check the results before committing.
6. Click RENAME and confirm.
7. Review the Results Grid, green rows are successes, red rows are errors.

i Changing the text field automatically cancels any in-progress preview scan, so you never see stale preview results.

5. How to Use ANE (Step-by-Step)

6.1 Selecting a Target Folder

Click the Browse button next to the Target Path field. A standard folder browser opens. Select the folder whose contents you want to rename and click OK. The full path will appear in the path box.

i Changing the target path automatically unchecks Include Subfolders, preventing accidental recursive operations on an unintended path.

6.2 Choosing an Operation

Operation	What it does
Add	Inserts text at the Beginning or End of a filename (before the extension for files).
Remove	Deletes a specific piece of text from the Beginning, End, or Anywhere in a filename.
Replace	Finds a specific text pattern and replaces it with something else throughout the filename.

6.3 Target Type

Choose what ANE should rename:

- Files only , only files in the target folder
- Folders only , only sub-folders
- Both , files and folders together

6.4 Text Entry

Depending on the operation selected, you will see one or two text fields:

- Text to Add / Remove: the exact text to insert or delete
- Text to Replace: the text you want to find (shown when Replace is selected)
- Replacement Text: what the found text will be changed to

6.5 Optional Filters

Keyword Filter

Enter a word or symbol in the Filter by Keyword field. ANE will only rename items whose names contain that word (respecting case sensitivity).

Format Filter

Choose a file extension from the Format dropdown (e.g. .mp3) to limit operations to files of that type. Choose Custom format to type your own extension.

Case Sensitive Renaming

When enabled (the default), 'Draft' and 'draft' are treated as different words. When disabled, the match is flexible regardless of capitalisation.

Include Subfolders

Check Include Subfolders to rename items in sub-folders too. A Depth selector appears, populated automatically from the actual folder structure. Choose 1, 2, ..., N levels deep, or Unlimited. The depth scan runs in the background, you can continue setting other options while it runs.

6.6 Preview Functionality

Click PREVIEW (5) at any time before renaming. ANE scans up to 100 matching items in the background and opens a Preview window showing 10 items per page.

- Use Previous and Next buttons to page through all results
- Each row shows: #, full path, type (File or Folder), current name, and new name
- Double-click any row to open that exact item in Windows Explorer
- The page counter shows 'Page 2 of 7 | 65 item(s) scanned'

⚠ Files that have no file extension may appear in the Preview window. This is expected behaviour and does not indicate a problem, only items whose names actually match your settings will be renamed.

6.7 Running the Rename

- Step 1. **Click RENAME** A confirmation dialog will appear.
- Step 2. **Click Yes** to proceed. ANE begins renaming in a background thread.
- Step 3. **Watch the progress bar** at the bottom. The status label shows the current progress.
- Step 4. **Click STOP at any time** to halt the operation mid-process.
- Step 5. **Review the Results Grid** when the operation completes.

The Results Grid shows every processed item with:

- # , row counter for easy reference
- Previous Name , the original name
- New Name , the name after renaming
- Result , green Success or red Error with details

6.8 Exporting Results

Click EXPORT RESULTS to save the results grid as a CSV file. The file will contain all four columns (#, Previous Name, New Name, Result) and can be opened in Excel or any spreadsheet application.

6.9 Files Without Extensions

Some files, particularly on Linux/macOS-origin drives, developer tools, or certain database files, do not have a file extension. ANE handles these files correctly:

- They may appear in the Preview window as potential rename candidates
- They will only be renamed if their name genuinely matches the current rename criteria
- They will not be renamed if the match is only incidental (such as appearing because they are in a scanned folder)

i Therefore if you see an unexpected file without an extension in the Preview, it simply means it was found during the scan. Check whether its name actually matches your criteria before proceeding with the rename.

6.10 Using the Live Path Search Window

Click LIVE SEARCH in the main toolbar to open the standalone search window.

- Step 1. **Enter the path to search in** using the Browse button or by typing directly.
- Step 2. **Enter a search term** (the word or phrase to look for in item names).
- Step 3. **Choose what to search:** Files only, Folders only, or Files & Folders.
- Step 4. **Set the subfolder depth:** root only, 1–5 levels, or unlimited.
- Step 5. **Toggle case sensitivity** if needed (off by default in Live Search).
- Step 6. **Click SEARCH.** The search runs in the background; the current folder being scanned is shown in the status bar.
- Step 7. **Click STOP at any time** to cancel the search.

Once results appear, you can:

- Click a row to select it (Ctrl+Click or Shift+Click for multiple rows)
- Click Select All to select every row
- Double-click a row to open that item in Explorer
- Right-click for a context menu: Copy Path or Open in Explorer

With one or more rows selected, three action buttons become available:

Action	What happens
Copy to...	Copies all selected items to a folder you choose. Items remain in their original location.
Move to...	Moves all selected items to a folder you choose. Items are removed from their original location.
Delete (Recycle)	Sends selected items to the Windows Recycle Bin. A confirmation dialog appears first. If a file is protected or locked, ANE will offer to retry with Administrator privileges.

6. Examples & Use Cases

7.1 Removing a Common Prefix from Photo Files

Scenario: 500 photos downloaded from a camera are all named IMG_20240101_001.jpg, IMG_20240101_002.jpg, etc. You want to remove the 'IMG_' prefix.

8. Set Target Path to the photos folder.
9. Operation: Remove, Position: Beginning of the name, Text: IMG_
10. Target Type: Files only, Format: .jpg
11. Click PREVIEW to verify, then RENAME.

7.2 Adding a Version Tag to All Text Files

Scenario: You want to add _v2 to the end of every .txt filename before the extension.

12. Operation: Add, Position: End of the name, Text: _v2
13. Target Type: Files only, Format: .txt
14. Click RENAME.

7.3 Replacing Spaces with Underscores

Scenario: A folder of audio files uses spaces in names, which causes issues with some software.

15. Operation: Replace, Text to Replace: (a space), Replacement Text: _
16. Target Type: Files only
17. Enable Case Sensitive: off (spaces are not case-sensitive anyway)
18. PREVIEW first, then RENAME.

7.4 Renaming Deep Folder Structures

Scenario: A project directory has many nested sub-folders, all containing files named draft_. You want to rename them recursively.

19. Set the project root as Target Path.
20. Check Include Subfolders, choose Unlimited depth.
21. Set your rename criteria as normal.
22. PREVIEW to confirm scope, then RENAME.

7.5 Finding and Deleting Duplicate Thumbnail Files

Scenario: After copying files between drives, hundreds of Thumbs.db cache files ended up everywhere.

23. Open LIVE SEARCH.
24. Search term: Thumbs.db, Depth: Unlimited.
25. Click Select All once results load.
26. Click Delete (Recycle) and confirm.

7. Warnings & Important Notes

⚠ ANE renames files and folders directly on your system. While every precaution is taken, always back up critical data before running large rename operations on important directories.

8.1 Preview May Show Unexpected Files

The Preview window scans your target folder and shows all items that could potentially be affected. You may occasionally see:

- Files with no extension, these are scanned but will only be renamed if they genuinely match the operation criteria.
- System or hidden files, ANE automatically excludes known Windows-managed files (desktop.ini, thumbs.db, Office lock files starting with ~\$, and files with the System attribute) from both Preview and renaming.

i Seeing a file in Preview does not guarantee it will be renamed. Only files whose names satisfy your exact settings will be changed.

8.2 Subfolder Checkbox Resets on Path Change

Every time you change the Target Path, the Include Subfolders checkbox is automatically unchecked. This is intentional, it prevents accidentally applying a deep recursive rename to a new path you haven't reviewed yet.

8.3 Case Sensitivity

Case sensitivity is ON by default. 'Draft' and 'draft' are different words. If your files have inconsistent capitalisation, turn case sensitivity off before renaming.

8.4 Files Open in Another Application

ANE cannot rename a file that is currently open in another application (such as a document open in Word). The Results Grid will show an error for that specific file. Close the file in the other application and re-run the rename.

8.5 Network Drives and Removable Media

ANE works on network drives and USB drives. However, some network locations may be slower, and the Recycle Bin may not be available for network paths. In such cases, the delete operation in Live Search will attempt a direct force-delete instead.

8.6 Administrator Privileges

Standard user accounts can rename most files. If you attempt to rename or delete a system-protected file and receive an Access Denied error, ANE will offer to retry the operation using Windows' built-in Administrator elevation (UAC prompt). Approve the UAC dialog to proceed.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
RENAME button does nothing	Ensure a valid Target Path is entered and the text field is not empty.
Preview shows 'No items would be affected'	Your criteria do not match any items in the selected folder. Check the operation, text, and filters.
Rename fails with 'Access Denied'	Close the file in any other application. If the issue persists, run ANE as Administrator (right-click > Run as Administrator).
SmartScreen blocks the installer	Click 'More info' then 'Run anyway'. The warning is due to the absence of a commercial code-signing certificate, not a security threat.
PowerShell script won't run	Open PowerShell as Administrator and run: Set-ExecutionPolicy - Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned
Live Search never finishes	Click STOP to cancel. Then narrow the search depth or start from a more specific folder.
Results grid is empty after rename	Click CLEAR RESULTS and try again. The grid may have been cleared accidentally.
Files with special characters in names fail	ANE uses LiteralPath internally, which supports all valid Windows filename characters. Ensure the path is accessible.
Delete in Live Search fails for a locked file	The file is in use. Close the application holding it and try again. If it is a system file, use the Administrator elevation option ANE offers.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Does ANE modify the content of my files?

A: No. ANE only changes the name of items. File contents, creation dates, and all other metadata are fully preserved.

Q: Can I undo a rename?

A: ANE does not have a built-in undo function. Before a large rename, always use PREVIEW to verify, and consider making a backup of the folder. You can re-run a rename in reverse (e.g. replace the new prefix with the old one) to undo manually.

Q: Is ANE free?

A: Currently, May 2026, yes, it's a freeware.

Q: Why do some files appear in Preview but don't get renamed?

A: Files are shown in Preview if they are found during the scan of the target folder. Only files whose names actually satisfy your rename criteria will be changed. Files without extensions, or files whose names only partially match, may appear but not be renamed.

Q: Can ANE rename files on a network drive?

A: Yes. Enter the network path (e.g. \\Server\Share\Folder) in the Target Path box. Performance may be slower over a network connection.

Q: What happens if the new name already exists?

A: ANE detects naming conflicts and automatically adds a numeric suffix (e.g. filename_1, filename_2) to prevent overwrites.

Q: Can I search for files by content, not just by name?

A: No. ANE searches and renames based on file and folder names only. Content-based search is outside its scope.

Q: Why does the Include Subfolders checkbox uncheck itself when I change the path?

A: This is a safety feature. It prevents accidentally running a recursive rename on a new, unreviewed path.

Q: Can I export the search results from Live Search?

A: Yes. After a search, click Export CSV in the Live Search window to save all results as a CSV file.

Q: Does ANE work on Windows 7 or 8?

A: ANE is designed and tested for Windows 10 and Windows 11. It may work on older versions, but these are not officially supported.

11. Contact & Support

For support, feature requests, bug reports, or general information, please use the following channels:

Channel	Details
Email	avarwand@yahoo.com
YouTube Channel	www.youtube.com/@avarwands
GitHub	Avarwand/ANE

 When reporting a bug, please include: the version of ANE, your Windows version, the operation you were performing, and any error message shown.